



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Loveland Classical School: Academy Campus
School Website: <https://www.lovelandclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Loveland Classical School Academy Campus Co 80537 presents itself as a public charter K–12 institution with a classical branding and a mission centered on character formation, virtuous conduct, and partnership with parents. Public-facing materials emphasize virtue, critical thinking, academic effort, and the cultivation of core virtues as guiding aims. The site does not prominently advertise explicit theology, liturgical practices, or a Great Books-based curriculum. It does, however, foreground character formation, virtues, and parental partnership as central to its mission.

Overall, based on the six-category classical-rubric, the school shows clear alignment with certain classical aims (notably in School Purpose and Goal and Parents & Community) but limited explicit evidence across Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Faculty, and only partial alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The aggregate assessment is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with concrete strengths in virtuous formation and family partnership, and notable missing anchors such as explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium coverage, and the full range of Scholé-style pedagogy in public-facing materials.

Key takeaways: - Strengths: Emphasis on virtuous character, moral formation, and family partnership; public articulation of core virtues and a mission centered on excellence and service; visible commitment to parental involvement. - Gaps: Absence of explicit Great Books/Trivium-based curriculum language, explicit theology or liturgical practice, and explicit pedagogy markers (Socratic dialogue, Scholé rhythms, memorization/recitation) in the public materials.

Evidence anchors include Loveland Classical Schools' mission statements and public materials, which emphasize virtue, critical thinking, and character development, and the school's public charter identity and parental partnership language. See: Loveland Classical Schools mission and values, including the twelve core virtues and virtue-focused framing.

- Executive details and site scope (incl. two campuses, Core Knowledge framing) from the crawl materials also shape the assessment of the Curriculum and Pedagogy categories.
- Classical-lexicon and Six Essential Elements framework underpin the keyword-based evaluation below, with explicit positive/negative keyword indicators for each category. See the classicality lexicon and the Six Essential Elements keyword indicators.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

The following sections lay out the category-specific keyword analyses, the evidence, and the justification for each classification, followed by concrete needle-moving recommendations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize virtuous character, moral formation, and core virtues as central aims of education. The mission describes developing virtuous character, critical thinking, and the joy of learning, with an emphasis on ethical virtues and stewardship. This signals a transcendently oriented moral formation, albeit not explicitly theological, liturgical, or metaphysical in the public-facing text.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon and its Positive Keywords for this element): virtue, character, moral formation, core virtues, ethical virtues, human flourishing.
 - Negative keywords present: None detected in the public materials (no value-neutral or secular-relativist framing found in the visible text).
 - Proportion estimate: Approximately 3–4 positive indicators vs 0 negative indicators observed in the public materials. This yields a leaning toward a classical orientation in this category, though the absence of explicit theology, liturgy, or liturgical practices weighs toward a partial (not full) alignment.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly foregrounds virtue, character formation, and moral deliberation, which align with transcendental moral realism and virtue-centered aims typical of classical education. However, there is no explicit, ongoing articulation of theology, liturgical practice, or sacral communal practice in the public-facing materials. This combination supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than CLASSICAL.
- Supporting sources
 - Mission and values emphasizing virtue and core virtues.
 - Lexicon framing of virtue and moral realism as positive indicators for this element.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission explicitly centers on virtuous character, critical thinking, and learning as a pathway to responsible citizenship and community stewardship, with an emphasis on diligence, excellence, and moral formation. These themes align with formation-focused aims and telos-driven education rather than mere job training.
 - The stated emphasis on “The pursuit of excellence through vigorous diligence” and “the habituation of ethical virtues” further signals a formation-first orientation consistent with classical aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue/virtues, character, moral formation, excellence, critical thinking, hard work, stewardship, responsibilities, truth/teleology (via telos-like framing in aims), love of learning (implied by mission language).
 - Negative keywords present: None evident in the public-facing content (no explicit workforce-readiness, career-preparation framing, or relativistic ethics).
 - Proportion estimate: Strong presence of formation/virtue/critical-thinking language with no competing negative framing; roughly a majority of the relevant indicators appear.
- Why this rating
 - The explicit emphasis on formation, virtue, and moral character, combined with the lack of explicit job/prep framing in the public materials, aligns well with the classical view of education as formation toward human excellence. The strength of these indicators justifies CLASSICAL for this category.
- Supporting sources

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- Mission text emphasizing virtuous character, critical thinking, excellence, and service.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe the school as a Core Knowledge K–12 public charter with two campuses, which signals a curriculum oriented toward foundational knowledge bases rather than a Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or Trivium/Quadrivium framework commonly associated with classical education. This (Core Knowledge) is not aligned with a classical curriculum emphasis on Great Books or the Trivium/Quadrivium sequence.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords (from classical curriculum indicators) such as Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, and the explicit Seven Liberal Arts are not present in the public materials.
 - Negative keywords include references to “Core Knowledge” and non-Great-Books curricular framing (explicitly present in the crawl). This alignment with Core Knowledge is a negative indicator for a strict classical curriculum framework.
 - Proportion estimate: Positive keywords observed: 0; Negative keywords observed: 1 (Core Knowledge framing) or more if counting other non-classical elements; overall leaning toward NOT CLASSICAL for this category.
- Why this rating
 - The absence of explicit Great Books, liberal-arts sequence (grammar/logic/rhetoric; trivium/quadrivium), and classical-curriculum language means the school does not demonstrate the core Curriculum criteria of classical education in its public-facing materials. The Core Knowledge framing is a notable departure from classical curriculum norms.
- Supporting sources
 - Core Knowledge framing on the public-facing site.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials do not describe the typical classical pedagogy elements (Socratic dialogue, Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, or mastery through imitation). The site emphasizes character formation and critical thinking, but there is no explicit description of contemplative pedagogy, Socratic seminars, or memorization-centered practices in the public-facing content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords for Pedagogy include Socratic Dialogue and Dialectic, Restful Learning (Scholé), Memorization and Recitation, and Formation through Imitation and Practice (per the Six Essential Elements lexicon). The school's public materials do not present these specific pedagogical methods.
 - Negative keywords (from the Pedagogy element) such as direct instruction or purely experiential/project-based approaches are not necessarily present; however, the absence of classical pedagogy markers is a negative signal for this category.
 - Proportion estimate: Positive keyword presence: 0; Negative signals: 0 (no explicit contrary language), but the absence of classical pedagogy indicators yields NOT CLASSICAL by default for this category.
- Why this rating
 - Without explicit articulation of classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, Scholé, memorization/recitation, or imitation-based practice) in public materials, the Pedagogy category does not demonstrate the hallmark teaching methods of classical education.
- Supporting sources
 - Public site lacks explicit pedagogy language; no Socratic/Scholé/Memorization references in the visible content.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials do not describe faculty as living curriculum, as model-virtue mentors, or as a portrait of teacher ideals; there is no explicit language about mentorship culture, teacher-as-model, or a “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty as a living curriculum.” The material focuses on mission, virtues, and parental partnership rather than faculty-themed classical pedagogy language.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords for Faculty include: teachers as models of virtue, mentorship, portrait of a teacher, living curriculum, collegiality, and virtuous leadership. These appear in classical rubrics but are not present in Loveland Classical School’s public materials.
 - Negative keywords (per the Six Elements lexicon) such as “facilitators on the side,” “non-classical teacher roles,” or “solo instruction” could indicate non-classical forms; none are explicitly stated in the site content, but the absence of the classical faculty language is a signal.
 - Proportion estimate: Positive keyword presence: 0; Negative indicator presence: 0; Overall NOT CLASSICAL due to absence of explicit faculty/mentorship language.
- Why this rating
 - Absence of explicit faculty-as-living-curriculum and mentorship-focused language means the Faculty element does not meet the Classical standard in public communications.
- Supporting sources
 - Site content focused on mission and virtues; no explicit faculty-living-curriculum language.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site emphasizes partnering with parents and championing virtues, which aligns with the classical model of parent-teacher partnership and family involvement. The mission text describes partnering with parents to cultivate virtuous character and responsible stewardship, which maps well to the Positive Keywords around Partnership with Families and Formation of Affections.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families, Formation of Affections, Cultural Transmission (as per the Six Essential Elements lexicon). The school’s mission language demonstrates partnership with parents and a family-centered approach to moral formation.
 - Negative keywords present: None observed in public materials.
 - Proportion estimate: Positive keyword presence is strong (multiple indicators), with no negative indicators observed.
- Why this rating
 - Strong alignment with the classical Parents & Community element: explicit partnership with parents, formation of affections, and transmission of cultural/civilizational heritage through family and school collaboration.
- Supporting sources
 - Our Mission statements emphasize parent partnership and core virtues; alignment with the Keyword indicators for the Parents & Community element.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school aims to advance toward a full CLASSICAL designation, the following needle-moving steps are recommended:
 - Curriculum shift: Introduce explicit classical-curriculum language and components (Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books) into formal communications and planning, or clearly map Core Knowledge into a classical framework where appropriate, and articulate how Great Books or canonical texts are integrated.

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- Pedagogy adoption: Incorporate visible classical pedagogy markers (Socratic dialogue, Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, and imitation of masterworks) into the school's approach and provide public examples of these methodologies in practice.
 - Theology/Liturgy clarity (where appropriate): If the school intends to maintain a non-religious or secular charter identity, clarify the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category's stance (e.g., move toward a more explicit explanation of transcendental aims or, conversely, justify secular humanist alignment with classical formation). If the school intends to incorporate religious elements, articulate them clearly in policy and practice, including liturgical and communal practices, while staying within charter commitments.
 - Faculty development: Highlight a faculty profile that positions teachers as living exemplars of virtue and mentors for students, with explicit statements about teacher formation and pedagogy aligned to classical aims.
 - Curriculum transparency: Publish a publicly accessible curriculum map that demonstrates the alignment with classical aims (liberal arts, Great Conversation, Great Books, primary sources) and how students engage with canonical texts or foundational thinkers.
 - Deepen Great Books/Great Conversation engagement: If staying with a classical aim, explicitly incorporate Great Conversation through canonical texts and structured discussions, including opportunities for student-led inquiry, Socratic seminars, and rhetoric training for upper grades.
- Rationale: The needle-moving changes focus on making explicit the classical elements already present in the school's mission (virtue formation, parent partnership) and addressing the current gaps in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Faculty language to reach a full CLASSICAL designation.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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